INVOICE TEMPLATE

The Rate Guide — Freelancer's Contract Pack

A professional invoice does three things: gets you paid, creates a paper trail, and signals that you run a real business.

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

Fill every `[BLANK]`. Number your invoices sequentially and keep a copy of each one. Your invoice number and project reference make it easy for client accounting teams to match your invoice to their purchase order — which is the thing that actually gets you paid faster.

Delete all annotation text before sending.

INVOICE

[YOUR NAME OR BUSINESS NAME]

[Your Address — City, State, ZIP]

[Your Email]

[Your Phone — optional]

[Your Website — optional]

[Your EIN or SSN — optional, but some clients require it for W-9 / 1099 purposes]

INVOICE TO:

[Client Company Name]

[Client Address]

[Client Email for billing]

Invoice #:	[INV-001 — number sequentially]
Invoice Date:	[Today's date]
Due Date:	[15 or 30 days from today, per contract terms]
Project:	[Project name]
PO # (if applicable):	[Client's purchase order number — ask for this before invoicing large corporate clients]

> **DECISION** *Always ask if the client has a purchase order number before invoicing large production companies or corporate clients. Without a PO, their accounting system may reject your invoice entirely and you'll add 30–60 days to your wait time just to get the paperwork aligned.*

SERVICES

DESCRIPTION	DAYS / HOURS / UNITS	RATE	AMOUNT
[Service description — e.g., Director of Photography — Shoot Day]	[X days]	$[Rate]/day	$[X × Rate]
[Service description — e.g., Post-Production — Offline Edit]	[X days]	$[Rate]/day	$[X × Rate]
[Service description — e.g., Color Grade + Delivery]	[X days]	$[Rate]/day	$[X × Rate]
[Service description — e.g., Additional Revision Round (CO-001)]	[X hrs]	$[Rate]/hr	$[Amount]

> **DECISION** *Reference Change Order numbers (CO-001, etc.) when invoicing for out-of-scope work. This links the invoice line item back to a signed document, which eliminates any dispute about whether the work was authorized.*

EQUIPMENT AND MATERIALS

[Delete this section if not applicable. Only include if you billed for equipment in your quote.]

DESCRIPTION	DAYS	RATE	AMOUNT
[Equipment item — e.g., Camera Package: ARRI Alexa Mini + lenses]	[X]	$ [Rate] /day	$ [Total]
[Equipment item — e.g., Lighting Kit]	[X]	$ [Rate] /day	$ [Total]
[Media / Data — e.g., 2× 1TB SanDisk Extreme Pro]	—	—	$ [Total]

EXPENSES

[Delete this section if there are no reimbursable expenses. Only include pre-approved expenses.]

DESCRIPTION	RECEIPT DATE	AMOUNT
[Expense — e.g., Parking at location — Lot A]	[Date]	$ [Amount]
[Expense — e.g., Mileage — [X] miles at IRS rate]	[Date]	$ [Amount]
[Expense — e.g., Hard drive — Western Digital 2TB — for project media]	[Date]	$ [Amount]

> **DECISION** *Attach receipts for all expense line items. No receipt, no reimbursement — clients will push back on undocumented expenses, and rightfully so. For mileage, use the current IRS standard mileage rate (check IRS.gov for the current year's rate) and log start/end addresses.*

SUMMARY

Services Subtotal	$ [Amount]
Equipment Subtotal	$ [Amount or "—"]
Expenses Subtotal	$ [Amount or "—"]
Invoice Total	**$ [Total]**
Less: Deposit Paid [Date]	- $ [Deposit amount or "—"]
AMOUNT DUE	**$ [Net amount due]**

PAYMENT INFORMATION

> **DECISION** *Provide at least two payment methods. ACH / bank transfer is best — no processing fees, clear paper trail. List the one you prefer first.*

ACH / Bank Transfer (preferred)

Bank: `[Bank Name]`

Account Name: `[Your Name / Business Name]`

Routing Number: `[XXXXXXXXX]`

Account Number: `[XXXXXXXXXX]`

> **DECISION** *If you're uncomfortable listing full banking info on an invoice, use a service like Bill.com, Melio, or Mercury that gives you a secure payment link instead. This is increasingly standard and safer than emailing banking details.*

Check

Make payable to: `[Your Name / Business Name]`

Mail to: `[Your Address]`

Venmo / PayPal / Other

`[Handle or email — only if you accept these. Note that PayPal charges a fee for business payments; factor that into your rate or add a fee note.]`

PAYMENT TERMS

Payment is due by `[Due Date]`. Invoices unpaid after the due date accrue interest at `[1.5%]`**/month** on the outstanding balance, per Section 2D of the signed Freelance Services Agreement.

If you have questions about this invoice, contact: `[Your Email]`

NOTES

`[Optional. Use this space for:]`

- *"Thank you for the project — it was a pleasure working with you."*
- *"Please note our updated banking information for this invoice."*

- *"Per our agreement, this invoice covers services through `[Date]`. Remaining deliverables will be invoiced upon completion."*
- *"W-9 attached per your request."*

> ***Invoice Best Practices***

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> ***Send the invoice the day the work is done.*** *Not three weeks later. Every day you wait is a day you've given the client a free loan.*

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> ***Follow up at 7 days.*** *A short, friendly email: "Just checking in on Invoice #INV-001 — wanted to make sure it was received." This is not aggressive. It is professional. Accounting teams are busy and invoices get lost.*

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> ***Follow up at 15 days (past due).*** *This time, reference the late fee clause. You don't have to be rude — just factual. "Invoice #INV-001 is now past due. Per our agreement, late fees of [X]% begin accruing from today. Please advise on payment status."*

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> ***Get a client's billing contact before the project starts.*** *The person who hired you is often not the person who processes payments. Ask: "Who should I send invoices to, and do you have a purchase order number I should reference?" Asking this before the project starts makes you look professional. Asking it after makes you look like an afterthought.*

Prepared with The Rate Guide Freelancer's Contract Pack. therateguide.com